

1938, July 18

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

Thence we crossed over St. Louis River to Duluth where we found some old friends from Hudson. Tuesday was short and busy, from the fact that we were to leave for St. Paul about 2 P.m. We arrived via St. Cloud and Minneapolis about 5:30-6 P.m. It was an up-to-date train. Aug. 19th, Thursday, we went over to Stillwater and visited St. Michael's Church, School and Convent. Things are kept in excellent condition. Dear old St. Michael's! The surroundings and views from familiar vantage points are perhaps as beautiful to the younger generation as they were to me fifty or sixty years ago; but to me! Only in the beautiful old Church itself, seemingly unchanged, could I have lingered longer. We sped down Third Avenue and steep Chestnut St., where in 1887 I learned to run the trolley-cars. At the foot of Chestnut, as of old, we crossed on the new bridge, now without toll or a draw and perhaps ten feet higher than was the old draw-bridge. Going down through Wisconsin scenery that still seemed familiar, we had dinner and a congenial visit with Monsignor Owens, who was ordained just a year ahead of Fr. Maurice J. and Master of Ceremonies at his First Holy Mass. We found him, however, in bad shape with some kind of rheumatism. Afterwards we speeded out the old road so familiar in younger, to church-going days to Burkhardt, Boardman and New Richmond. The others waited under the maples for our first stop while Fr. Edward and I climbed the old entrance to the Roberts Estate. We found, I'm inclined to say, poor little Emma, so modest and winsome in school-days and later when Fr. S. helped her Father with the Spring work. She seemed quite alone though gently contented and friendly, but of course a little more now than fifteen. The older of the two, Anna, perhaps more ambitious, married and became a venerated grandma. One of her four sons, I believe, became a professor at Cornell. Her husband died a few years since and the last I heard the two were again together on the farm.

Next stop was at the Diehl-Germain home. They, too, were surprised. Anna is the old lady now, and Joe, the old man, quite literally. Thence down across the old bridge and over to Fr. Edward's childhood chum, William Ryan, and wife Agnes, living in Andy Tobin's old house. Leaving the others there, Fr. S. hiked over to Baker's and after a short visit with the dear old lady and Mary, strolled down to the one-time beautiful Drydam.

In the meantime, the others came and took a longer hike. The old mill at Burkhardt would seem to have been shell shocked or something like that. It has not moved since the war No. 1